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Red Flags to Watch Out for in Scams



We have all received suspicious messages, whether through calls claiming that we have won a grand prize in a competition we never entered, or emails from 'police officers' threatening legal action if alleged outstanding fines are not settled immediately. Although we often consider ourselves seasoned users of digital technology and the internet, digital fraud can still deceive us.

With the rapid advancements in digital technology, particularly in the financial sector, fraud and misconduct are now rampant in Malaysia. Catching red flags of scams early on can help protect your hard-earned money and savings.

Can you spot the red flags?

Here are some instances in which you may have encountered yourself and wondered, “Is this a scam?”

Situation 1



Pak Ahmad receives a call from an unknown private number. The caller claims to be a police officer and informs that Pak Ahmad's personal data has been compromised. The caller urgently requests his bank account information for verification and asks Pak Ahmad to confirm the transaction authentication code (TAC) he received

Red Flag 1: Contacted out of the blue with a private number.

Authorities and financial institutions will not contact you using a private number. If you receive a call from an unknown private number, be cautious. Always verify the contact details on the official website of the institution or organisation in question.

Red Flag 2: Creating a sense of urgency.

Scammers often use a sense of urgency to pressure you into making hasty decisions. They may employ threatening language or imply immediate action is required, which can cloud your judgement and discourage you from questioning the legitimacy of the situation.

Red Flag 3: Requesting private information.

Authorities and legitimate financial institutions will not request personal information via telephone, email, or messages. Exercise caution if you receive calls asking for details such as:

- Credit or debit card number and CVV
- Online banking username and password
- OTP or TAC codes received via text messages